

return to secular patronage. He seriously considered a post at the royal court of Poland and sought to attract the attention of the Holy Roman Emperor in Vienna. However, in the end he remained at St. Mark's for the rest of his days, constantly muttering about inadequate pay and worrying about an unpaid pension he was owed from Mantua.



ST. MARK'S BASILICA, VENICE

Monteverdi was appointed director of music at the magnificent basilica in Venice when he was in his mid-forties and stayed there for the rest of his life.

New horizons

Remarkably, in his seventies, a crotchety old man, Monteverdi produced a late flowering of creativity, with his last two operas exploring new frontiers in musical theater. They followed from the opening of the world's first public opera houses in Venice at the end of the 1630s.

The operas that Monteverdi wrote to be staged at the Teatro